

اردو شاعری

URDU FOR POETRY LOVERS

VOLUME 1 • 100 WORDS THAT OPEN THE GHAZAL

*A listener-first guide to the language of love, longing,
beauty, fate, mysticism and poetic form*

Prepared for

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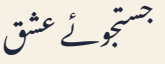
How to Use This Guide

The goal is recognition before fluency. You do not need formal Urdu before poetry starts opening. First hear recurring emotional words, then recognise their written shapes, and finally notice how poets connect them through compounds such as gham-e-dil and shab-e-hijr.

1 • HEAR	2 • CONNECT	3 • RECOGNISE	4 • RETURN
Say the Roman form aloud and attach one clear meaning.	Link it to a related word, image, song title or poet.	Notice the Urdu shape without forcing yourself to write it yet.	Re-listen to one ghazal and mark every word you catch.

One Device Changes Everything: Izafat

The small sound -e- often means “of” or joins two poetic images. It is a Persian connector and is usually not written as a separate full letter. Once your ear catches it, long phrases break into familiar pieces.

 gham-e-dil sorrow of the heart	 shab-e-hijr night of separation	 justuju-e-ishq the quest for love
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Pronunciation: Only What You Need First

SIGN	APPROXIMATE SOUND	TRY IT WITH
aa	long ‘a’	jaan, nigaah, bahaar
oo	long ‘u’	rooh, sukoon, justuju
kh • خ	rougher than English k	khuda, khwaab, khauf
gh • غ	a voiced throat sound	gham, ghazal
q • ق	a deeper k; ordinary speech may soften it	qismat, qaafiya
,	a slight catch or separation	she’r; sometimes in Arabic-derived words

Important • Do not postpone listening until pronunciation is perfect. Recognition and emotional context come first; refinement follows.

The Ten Worlds You Will Learn

WORDS	WORLD	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
1–10	The Heart and Its Attachments	Urdu poetry begins in the heart, but it distinguishes gentle affection, consuming love, loyalty, the beloved, and the person who loves.
11–20	Separation, Longing and the Search	The ghazal often keeps fulfilment just out of reach. These words describe distance, waiting, memory, desire and the rare moment of union.
21–30	Sorrow, Tears and Complaint	Urdu gives sorrow a precise vocabulary—from quiet regret to burning anguish, from a single tear to a complaint addressed to God or the beloved.
31–40	Beauty, Glance and the Beloved	In the ghazal, beauty is rarely static. It appears through the beloved's glance, gesture, proud reserve, face, hair, lips and fragrance.
41–50	Wine, the Cupbearer and Mystical Intoxication	Wine imagery may be literal, romantic, rebellious or mystical. The tavern can stand for freedom, the cupbearer for a guide, and intoxication for love or spiritual ecstasy.
51–60	Moon, Night, Dawn and the Garden	Urdu poetry turns nature into an emotional landscape: moon as face, night as separation, dawn as hope, spring as renewal, and the garden as society or paradise.
61–70	Life, Fate and Time	These words widen a private love story into philosophy: what life is, what fate decides, what time changes, and where the journey leads.
71–80	World, God, Dream and Self	Urdu poetry moves easily between the worldly and sacred. A beloved can resemble God, a dream can challenge reality, and solitude can reveal the self.
81–90	Inner States and Human Voice	These words name what happens inside the speaker—patience, passion, peace, restlessness, silence, speech, secrecy, faith, hope and fear.
91–100	How a Ghazal Is Built	These final words reveal the architecture. Once you can identify a couplet, refrain, rhyme and pen name, listening becomes much more rewarding.

A Four-Week Rhythm

WEEK 1 Words 1–25 Love, separation, first sorrow	WEEK 2 Words 26–50 Sorrow, beauty, wine imagery	WEEK 3 Words 51–75 Nature, fate, world and prayer	WEEK 4 Words 76–100 Dream, inner states, ghazal form
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Daily practice: read five cards, speak each Roman word twice, cover the meaning and recall it, then listen to one song or ghazal for ten minutes. Your only task is to catch familiar words—not to translate every line.

Seven Small Words That Do Enormous Work

WORD	CORE JOB	HEAR IT AS
ka • ki • ke	possession / relation	of; belonging to
mein	location	in; inside
se	source / means / comparison	from; with; than
ko	object / recipient marker	to; toward
bhi	addition	also; even
hi	emphasis	precisely; indeed; only
na / nahin	negation	not; do not

Listening trick • Ignore verb endings on your first pass. Catch a content word such as dil or yaad, then use these small helpers to understand its relationship to the words around it.

The Heart and Its Attachments

دل اور محبت

Urdu poetry begins in the heart, but it distinguishes gentle affection, consuming love, loyalty, the beloved, and the person who loves.

01 • ISHQ • عشق

Meaning • intense, consuming or transformative love **Connection** • Stronger and more fated than ordinary mohabbat; connects to aashiq and junoon.

Memory hook • Think of the song title “Ishq Bina”—love as an element one cannot live without.

Try it • ishq ka safar = the journey of love

02 • MOHABBAT • محبت

Meaning • love, affection, loving attachment **Connection** • The broad everyday-poetic word for love; connects to mehboob and wafa.

Memory hook • The film title “Mohabbatein” turns this noun into a whole world of love stories.

Try it • mohabbat ki khushboo = the fragrance of love

03 • DIL • دل

Meaning • heart; the inner seat of emotion and courage **Connection** • Pairs endlessly with dard, gham, khwaab, sukoon and beqaraar.

Memory hook • “Dil Se” is the perfect memory key: something felt from the heart.

Try it • dil beqaraar hai = the heart is restless

04 • JAAN • جان

Meaning • life, soul; also an intimate name for a beloved **Connection** • In jaan-e-jaan, izafat links “life” to an intensely loved person.

Memory hook • Hear the affectionate address jaan-e-jaan in songs: literally, life of my life.

Try it • meri jaan = my life / my dear

05 • SANAM • صنم

Meaning • idol; poetically, the adored beloved **Connection** • The old image is deliberate: the lover worships the beloved like an idol.

Memory hook • The title “Sanam Re” makes the address easy to retain.

Try it • ae sanam = O beloved

06 • MEHBOOB • محبوب

Meaning • the loved one, beloved **Connection** • From the same Arabic root-family as mohabbat: love creates the loved one.

Memory hook • “Mehbooba Mehbooba” repeats the feminine form until it becomes unforgettable.

Try it • mehboob ki yaad = the beloved’s memory

07 • ULFAT • الفت

Meaning • affection, intimacy, loving attachment **Connection** • Softer than ishq; imagine the familiarity that grows through companionship.

Memory hook • In older film ghazals, teri ulfat means the bond of your love.

Try it • ulfat ka rang = the colour of affection

08 • WAFA • وفا

Meaning • faithfulness, loyalty, keeping faith in love **Connection** • Its dramatic opposite is bewafa; it also pairs with vaada, a promise.

Memory hook • Many ghazals turn on one question: did the beloved keep wafa?

Try it • wafa ka vaada = a promise of fidelity

09 • BEWAFAT • بے وفا

Meaning • unfaithful, disloyal **Connection** • The prefix be- means without: be + wafa = without faithfulness.

Memory hook • Remember the emotional world of “Achha Sila Diya”: betrayal is bewafai.

Try it • bewafa zamaana = an unfaithful world

10 • AASHIQ • عاشق

Meaning • lover; one overcome by love **Connection** • The person-form of ishq; the beloved is often mashooq, while the lover is aashiq.

Memory hook • The film title “Aashiqui” names the condition or story of being in love.

Try it • aashiq ka junoon = the lover’s passion

Separation, Longing and the Search

جدائی اور جستجو

The ghazal often keeps fulfilment just out of reach. These words describe distance, waiting, memory, desire and the rare moment of union.

11 • HIJR • ہجر

Meaning • separation from the beloved; the state of being apart **Connection** • The classical opposite is visaal. Shab-e-hijr means the night of separation.

Memory hook • When a poem makes one night feel endless, you are usually inside hijr.

Try it • shab-e-hijr = night of separation

12 • FIRAAQ • فراق

Meaning • separation, absence and longing **Connection** • Close to hijr, but often heard as the ache or interval of separation.

Memory hook • Poet Firaq Gorakhpuri chose this word as his pen name—a lasting memory anchor.

Try it • dard-e-firaaq = pain of separation

13 • JUDAAI • جدائی

Meaning • parting, separation **Connection** • More immediately understood in Hindustani speech; juda means separate.

Memory hook • “Lambi Judaai” fixes the word through the image of a long separation.

Try it • pal-e-judaai = the moment of parting

14 • VISAAL • وصال

Meaning • union, reunion or meeting with the beloved **Connection** • Pairs with hijr; in mystical poetry it can mean union with the Divine.

Memory hook • Remember the ghazal pendulum: hijr pulls apart, visaal brings together.

Try it • lamha-e-visaal = moment of union

15 • INTEZAAR • انتظار

Meaning • waiting, expectation **Connection** • Waiting turns ordinary time into emotional waqt.

Memory hook • “Inteha Ho Gayi Intezaar Ki” makes the meaning unmistakable.

Try it • tera intezaar = waiting for you

16 • YAAD • یاد

Meaning • memory, remembrance; the feeling of missing someone **Connection** • Can be a noun or action: yaad is memory; yaad karna is to remember.

Memory hook • “Yaad Aa Rahi Hai” is the everyday grammar of a memory returning.

Try it • teri yaad = your memory / missing you

17 • TAMANNA • تمنا

Meaning • desire, wish, cherished longing **Connection** • Often more tender than junoon and less wounded than hasrat.

Memory hook • The name and film title “Tamanna” both carry the sense of a heartfelt wish.

Try it • dil ki tamanna = the heart's desire

18 • HASRAT • حسرت

Meaning • unfulfilled desire, wistful longing, regret **Connection** • A tamanna may still come true; a hasrat often carries the ache of not having.

Memory hook • Lyricist Hasrat Jaipuri's pen name lets the word travel with classic cinema.

Try it • adhuri hasrat = an unfulfilled longing

19 • AARZU • آرزو

Meaning • desire, aspiration, longing **Connection** • Close to tamanna, but often nobler or more aspirational in tone.

Memory hook • The film title “Aarzoo” is simply this word stretched into a story of longing.

Try it • aarzu-e-dil = the heart's desire

20 • JUSTUJU • جستجو

Meaning • search, quest, persistent seeking **Connection** • A desire becomes justuju when it makes you search.

Memory hook • “Justuju Jiski Thi” is a direct mnemonic: the one for whom the search continued.

Try it • justuju-e-ishq = the quest for love

Sorrow, Tears and Complaint

غم، اشک اور فریاد

Urdu gives sorrow a precise vocabulary—from quiet regret to burning anguish, from a single tear to a complaint addressed to God or the beloved.

21 • GHAM • غم

Meaning • sorrow, grief, emotional burden **Connection** • The classic compound gham-e-dil is sorrow of the heart.

Memory hook • Think of the ghazal title “Gham Ka Khazana”—a treasury filled with grief.

Try it • gham-e-dil = sorrow of the heart

22 • DARD • درد

Meaning • pain, ache, suffering **Connection** • Can be bodily or emotional; dard-e-dil is the pain of the heart.

Memory hook • “Dard-e-Dil, Dard-e-Jigar” lets repetition teach the word.

Try it • dard-e-judaai = pain of separation

23 • ASHK • اشک

Meaning • tear; a literary word for a teardrop **Connection** • Aansoo is everyday; ashk is the word you are more likely to meet in a ghazal.

Memory hook • When eyes become poetic, aansoo often turn into ashk.

Try it • ashk-e-gham = tear of sorrow

24 • AANSOO • آنسو

Meaning • tear; the common spoken word **Connection** • The everyday counterpart of ashk; both connect eyes to gham.

Memory hook • The song title “Aansoo Bhari Hain” makes the image immediate.

Try it • aankh ka aansoo = a tear of the eye

25 • AAH • آہ

Meaning • sigh, cry of pain **Connection** • A tiny sound carrying dard; often appears at the opening of a line.

Memory hook • Recall Ghalib’s opening fragment “Aah ko chahiye...”—a sigh asking for effect.

Try it • dil ki aah = the heart’s sigh

26 • SOZ • سوز

Meaning • burning emotion, passion, pathos **Connection** • Not merely pain: it is pain that burns and gives feeling to voice or verse.

Memory hook • Soz-e-dil is the inner burn that makes a ghazal sound lived rather than recited.

Try it • soz-e-dil = the heart's burning pathos

27 • RANJ • رنج

Meaning • grief, hurt, trouble, distress **Connection** • Ranjish grows from ranj and means hurt, estrangement or grievance.

Memory hook • "Ranjish Hi Sahi" begins with the word-family of grief.

Try it • ranj-o-gham = grief and sorrow

28 • MALAAL • ملال

Meaning • regret, melancholy, subdued sadness **Connection** • Quieter than faryaad; the sadness remains inward.

Memory hook • The film title "Malaal" is a one-word lesson in lingering regret.

Try it • dil ka malaal = the heart's regret

29 • SHIKWA • شکوہ

Meaning • complaint, grievance, reproach **Connection** • A shikwa is articulated sorrow: pain that has found an addressee.

Memory hook • Iqbal's "Shikwa" and "Jawab-e-Shikwa" turn complaint into dialogue.

Try it • shikwa-e-dil = the heart's complaint

30 • FARYAAD • فریاد

Meaning • lament, cry for help, appeal **Connection** • More urgent than shikwa; sorrow becomes a call that asks to be heard.

Memory hook • The song title "Koi Fariyaad" is a direct path to the meaning.

Try it • meri faryaad = my lament / appeal

Beauty, Glance and the Beloved

حسن، نظر اور ادا

In the ghazal, beauty is rarely static. It appears through the beloved's glance, gesture, proud reserve, face, hair, lips and fragrance.

31 • HUSN • حسن

Meaning • beauty, loveliness **Connection** • Often paired with ishq: beauty attracts; love responds.

Memory hook • “Husn Hazir Hai” makes husn stand before you as visible beauty.

Try it • husn ka noor = the radiance of beauty

32 • JAMAAL • جمال

Meaning • beauty, splendour, graceful perfection **Connection** • Husn-o-jamaal is a common pairing that intensifies the idea of beauty.

Memory hook • Remember jamaal through the familiar names Jameel and Jamila: beautiful.

Try it • husn-o-jamaal = beauty and splendour

33 • NAZAR • نظر

Meaning • sight, glance, attention, viewpoint **Connection** • Nazar can fall, meet, protect, bless or harm; context decides.

Memory hook • “Nazar Ke Samne” places someone directly before the gaze.

Try it • teri nazar = your gaze

34 • NIGAAH • نگاہ

Meaning • gaze, look, regard **Connection** • More poetic and sustained than a casual nazar.

Memory hook • “Nigahen Milane Ko Jee Chahta Hai” centres the desire to meet gazes.

Try it • nigaah-e-karam = a gracious / merciful glance

35 • ADAA • ادا

Meaning • graceful style, gesture, manner, charm **Connection** • The beloved's smallest movement can become an adaa.

Memory hook • Picture classic screen icons: a turn of the wrist or eyebrow is an adaa.

Try it • naaz-o-adaa = coquetry and graceful charm

36 • NAAZ • ناز

Meaning • charming pride, coyness, pampered delicacy **Connection** • Often paired with adaa; the beloved knows their power and withholds a little.

Memory hook • Naaz-o-adaa is a compact formula for proud charm plus expressive grace.

Try it • naaz-e-sanam = the beloved's proud charm

37 • RUKH • رخ

Meaning • face; also direction or aspect **Connection** • A turned face can signal beauty, refusal or a change of direction.

Memory hook • Remember the double meaning: rukh badalna is to change direction or turn one's face.

Try it • rukh-e-roshan = radiant face

38 • ZULF • زلف

Meaning • lock or tress of hair **Connection** • Classical poetry makes the dark curl a snare, night, mystery or shelter.

Memory hook • "Yeh Reshmi Zulfen" turns hair into the central visual image.

Try it • zulf-e-siyaah = dark tress of hair

39 • LAB • لب

Meaning • lip; poetically, speech or a kiss **Connection** • The literary counterpart of hont; lab can be silent, smiling or rose-like.

Memory hook • Use "Hothon Se Chhoo Lo Tum" to connect everyday hont with poetic lab.

Try it • lab-e-khaamosh = silent lips

40 • KHUSHBOO • خوشبو

Meaning • fragrance, pleasant scent **Connection** • Khush means pleasant; boo means scent. The compound explains itself.

Memory hook • Gulzar's cinema repeatedly uses fragrance as the memory of someone absent.

Try it • gul ki khushboo = the flower's fragrance

Wine, the Cupbearer and Mystical Intoxication

مے، ساقی اور خمار

Wine imagery may be literal, romantic, rebellious or mystical. The tavern can stand for freedom, the cupbearer for a guide, and intoxication for love or spiritual ecstasy.

41 • MAI (MAY) • مے

Meaning • wine; the classical poetic word **Connection** • Do not confuse it with main, “I”. It combines with khaana to form maikhaana.

Memory hook • Hear may like the English month, then picture the ghazal’s wine.

Try it • mai-e-ishq = the wine of love

42 • SHARAAB • شراب

Meaning • wine, alcoholic drink **Connection** • More common and literal than mai, though poetry can spiritualise it too.

Memory hook • The film title “Sharaabi” names the person devoted to drink.

Try it • sharaab-e-ishq = the wine of love

43 • SAAQI • ساقی

Meaning • cupbearer, one who pours wine **Connection** • Can symbolise the beloved, poet, teacher or Divine source of ecstasy.

Memory hook • In a ghazal, the call saaqi tells you someone is being asked to pour.

Try it • ae saaqi = O cupbearer

44 • PAIMAANA • پیمانہ

Meaning • measure, goblet, wine-cup **Connection** • Its root sense is measurement; poetry turns the measure into the vessel.

Memory hook • Picture love being poured until the paimaana can hold no more.

Try it • paimaana-e-dil = the heart’s measure / cup

45 • JAAM • جام

Meaning • goblet, cup, wine-cup **Connection** • The jaam is the vessel; mai or sharaab is what fills it.

Memory hook • A raised jaam is one of the quickest signals of a ghazal’s tavern world.

Try it • jaam-e-mohabbat = the cup of love

46 • MAIKHAANA • مے خانہ

Meaning • tavern, house of wine **Connection** • A transparent compound: mai, wine + khaana, house or place.

Memory hook • Compare kitaab-khaana, a place of books, with mai-khaana, a place of wine.

Try it • raah-e-maikhana = the road to the tavern

47 • KHUMAAR • خمار

Meaning • lingering intoxication, dreamy after-effect **Connection** • More than drunkenness: the spell remains after the encounter has passed.

Memory hook • A remembered voice or glance can leave khumaar even without literal wine.

Try it • ishq ka khumaar = the intoxication of love

48 • MAST • مست

Meaning • intoxicated, ecstatic, carefree **Connection** • Can describe wine, love, music or spiritual absorption.

Memory hook • “Mast Qalandar” links mast with ecstatic, unrestrained devotion.

Try it • mast nigaah = an intoxicating / carefree gaze

49 • RIND • رند

Meaning • free-spirited drinker; worldly nonconformist **Connection** • The rind rejects public respectability and exposes hypocrisy.

Memory hook • Ghalib’s tavern persona often speaks like a rind: witty, wounded and unconstrained.

Try it • rind-e-maikhana = the tavern’s free spirit

50 • HOSH • ہوش

Meaning • consciousness, awareness, senses **Connection** • Its poetic opposite is intoxication, masti or be-khudi.

Memory hook • “Hoshwalon Ko Khabar Kya” asks what the sober can know of love.

Try it • hosh kho dena = to lose one’s senses

Moon, Night, Dawn and the Garden

چاند، شب اور بہار

Urdu poetry turns nature into an emotional landscape: moon as face, night as separation, dawn as hope, spring as renewal, and the garden as society or paradise.

51 • CHAAND • چاند

Meaning • moon **Connection** • The beloved's face is frequently compared to the moon.

Memory hook • "Chaudhvin Ka Chand" fixes the image of the full, beautiful moon.

Try it • chaand sa rukh = a moon-like face

52 • MAAH • ماہ

Meaning • moon; also month, in Persianate usage **Connection** • A more literary sibling of chaand; maah-e-taabaan is the shining moon.

Memory hook • When the beloved becomes maah, the moon has become Persian and courtly.

Try it • maah-e-taabaan = the radiant moon

53 • SHAB • شب

Meaning • night **Connection** • The literary counterpart of raat; pairs with hijr, tanhaai and mahtaab.

Memory hook • Replace raat with shab and a phrase instantly sounds more classical.

Try it • shab-e-hijr = night of separation

54 • SAHAR • سحر

Meaning • dawn, early morning **Connection** • The opposite movement from shab; it often symbolises freedom or renewal.

Memory hook • "Woh Subah Kabhi To Aayegi" carries the same hope that sahar will arrive.

Try it • sahar ki roshni = the light of dawn

55 • ROSHNI • روشنی

Meaning • light, illumination **Connection** • Can be literal or the light of knowledge, hope and presence.

Memory hook • A single roshni in a dark shab is the simplest image of hope.

Try it • umeed ki roshni = the light of hope

56 • NOOR • نور

Meaning • radiance, luminous or spiritual light **Connection** • More sacred or inward than ordinary roshni; found in noor-e-nazar.

Memory hook • Noor is not merely brightness—it is a presence that seems to shine from within.

Try it • noor-e-nazar = light of the eyes; dearly loved one

57 • Aaftaab • آفتاب

Meaning • sun **Connection** • Pairs beautifully with maah or mahtaab, the moon.

Memory hook • If chaand is the beloved's face, aaftaab is splendour too bright to confront.

Try it • aaftaab-e-sahar = sun of dawn

58 • Bahaar • بہار

Meaning • spring, bloom, flourishing season **Connection** • Can mean nature's spring or the return of joy and youth.

Memory hook • "Baharon Phool Barsao" turns spring into a welcoming celebration.

Try it • mausam-e-bahaar = the season of spring

59 • GUL • گل

Meaning • flower; often specifically a rose **Connection** • Forms gulshan, garden, and gulzaar, a flower-filled place.

Memory hook • Faiz's title fragment "Gulon mein rang bhare" gives flowers colour and movement.

Try it • rang-e-gul = the colour of the flower

60 • GULSHAN • گلشن

Meaning • garden, flower garden **Connection** • The place where gul grows; it can symbolise homeland, society or paradise.

Memory hook • Picture the ghazal's world as a gulshan: flowers, birds, spring and thorns.

Try it • gulshan ki bahaar = the garden's spring

Life, Fate and Time

زندگی، تقدیر اور وقت

These words widen a private love story into philosophy: what life is, what fate decides, what time changes, and where the journey leads.

61 • ZINDAGI • زندگی

Meaning • life; lived existence **Connection** • Warmer and more everyday than hayaat; pairs with safar, gham and khushi.

Memory hook • “Zindagi Kaisi Hai Paheli” presents life itself as a riddle.

Try it • zindagi ka safar = the journey of life

62 • HAYAAT • حیات

Meaning • life, existence; formal or literary **Connection** • Pairs with maut in philosophical and religious registers.

Memory hook • Think of hayaat-o-maut: life and death held in one balanced phrase.

Try it • raaz-e-hayaat = the secret of life

63 • MAUT • موت

Meaning • death **Connection** • The stark counterweight to zindagi and hayaat.

Memory hook • Classic cinema’s phrase zindagi aur maut makes the pair instantly audible.

Try it • maut ka khauf = fear of death

64 • TAQDEER • تقدیر

Meaning • destiny, what has been decreed **Connection** • Suggests a written or allotted destiny; connects to qismat.

Memory hook • Taqdeer ka likha imagines fate as writing already placed on the page.

Try it • taqdeer ka faisla = destiny’s decision

65 • QISMAT • قسمت

Meaning • fate, fortune, one’s allotted share **Connection** • More conversational than taqdeer and used for both luck and lot in life.

Memory hook • The classic film title “Qismat” makes fate the protagonist.

Try it • achchhi qismat = good fortune

66 • WAQT • وقت

Meaning • time; the moment or circumstances **Connection** • Waqt can heal, reveal, reverse and test.

Memory hook • The film title “Waqt” rests on the idea that time changes every position.

Try it • waqt ka faisla = time’s verdict

67 • ZAMAANA • زمانہ

Meaning • age, era, the times; society or the world **Connection** • Often acts like a collective judge: zamaana kya kahega?

Memory hook • “Zamana Kya Kahega” gives the word its social pressure.

Try it • badalta zamaana = the changing times

68 • UMR • عمر

Meaning • age, lifetime, span of life **Connection** • Umr bhar means throughout one’s life—a favourite promise in songs.

Memory hook • Whenever a lyric vows “for a lifetime”, listen for umr bhar.

Try it • umr bhar = for a lifetime

69 • LAMHA • لمحہ

Meaning • moment, instant **Connection** • A small unit of waqt that memory can make enormous.

Memory hook • The film title “Lamhe” pluralises the moments that shape a life.

Try it • ek lamha = one moment

70 • SAFAR • سفر

Meaning • journey, travel **Connection** • Can be physical, emotional or spiritual; life itself becomes a safar.

Memory hook • “Zindagi Ka Safar” joins two of the guide’s central words.

Try it • safar-e-hayaat = the journey of life

World, God, Dream and Self

دنیا، خدا، خواب اور وجود

Urdu poetry moves easily between the worldly and sacred. A beloved can resemble God, a dream can challenge reality, and solitude can reveal the self.

71 • DUNIYA • دنیا

Meaning • world; worldly or material life **Connection** • Can mean the physical world, society, or everything outside the lovers.

Memory hook • “Duniya Banane Wale” addresses the maker of this difficult world.

Try it • duniya ka gham = the world’s sorrow

72 • JAHAN • جہاں

Meaning • world, universe, realm; also “where” by context **Connection** • In poetry it often means the whole inhabited world.

Memory hook • Iqbal’s “Saare Jahan Se Achha” uses jahaan on a vast civilisational scale.

Try it • saara jahaan = the whole world

73 • KHUDA • خدا

Meaning • God, the Divine **Connection** • Appears in prayer, complaint, surrender and as metaphor for supreme belovedness.

Memory hook • “Khuda Jaane” means God knows—an everyday phrase made cinematic.

Try it • khuda ki marzi = God’s will

74 • DUA • دعا

Meaning • prayer, blessing, heartfelt wish **Connection** • A wish becomes a dua when offered with humility or sacred intention.

Memory hook • Visualise raised hands: dua is desire turned toward the Divine.

Try it • dua-e-khair = a prayer for well-being

75 • IBAADAT • عبادت

Meaning • worship, devotion **Connection** • Love poetry can deliberately blur loving a person with worship.

Memory hook • The cinematic idea of seeing the Divine in the beloved is ishq as ibaadat.

Try it • ishq ki ibaadat = the worship of love

76 • ROOH • روح

Meaning • soul, spirit **Connection** • Roohani means spiritual or soul-touching.

Memory hook • If dil is the emotional heart, rooh is the deeper animating spirit.

Try it • rooh ka sukoon = peace of the soul

77 • KHWAAAB • خواب

Meaning • dream **Connection** • Can mean a sleeping dream, fantasy, vision or unrealised future.

Memory hook • “Khwab Ho Tum Ya Koi Haqeeqat” asks whether the beloved is dream or reality.

Try it • adhura khwaab = an unfinished dream

78 • KHAYAAL • خیال

Meaning • thought, imagination, idea; also care or regard **Connection** • Tera khayaal can mean your thought, thinking of you, or care for you.

Memory hook • Khayaal is also a major form of Hindustani classical vocal music.

Try it • tera khayaal = the thought of you

79 • WAJOOD • وجود

Meaning • existence, being, presence **Connection** • More philosophical than zindagi; asks what it means to be.

Memory hook • The film title “Wajood” makes existence itself the question.

Try it • mera wajood = my existence / being

80 • TANHA • تنہا

Meaning • alone, solitary, lonely **Connection** • The noun is tanhaai, solitude or loneliness.

Memory hook • “Tanha Dil” links the lonely condition directly to the heart.

Try it • tanha safar = a solitary journey

Inner States and Human Voice

صبر، جنون اور گفتگو

These words name what happens inside the speaker—patience, passion, peace, restlessness, silence, speech, secrecy, faith, hope and fear.

81 • SABR • صبر

Meaning • patient endurance, steadfast restraint **Connection** • Not passive waiting: sabr is the strength to remain steady through pain.

Memory hook • The proverb about the fruit of patience makes sabr feel practical, not abstract.

Try it • sabr ka imtihaan = a test of patience

82 • JUNOON • جنون

Meaning • madness, obsession, consuming passion **Connection** • Ishq pushed beyond reason becomes junoon.

Memory hook • The many films and serials titled “Junoon” use passion bordering madness.

Try it • junoon-e-ishq = the madness of love

83 • SUKOON • سکون

Meaning • peace, repose, inner calm **Connection** • The opposite emotional movement from beqaraar and junoon.

Memory hook • Modern songs use sukoon constantly for the quiet one person’s presence brings.

Try it • dil ka sukoon = peace of the heart

84 • BEQARAAR • بے قرار

Meaning • restless, uneasy, unable to settle **Connection** • Be- means without; qaraar is rest or stability.

Memory hook • “Beqarar Karke Humein Yun Na Jaiye” teaches the state through its title.

Try it • dil beqaraar = a restless heart

85 • KHAAMOSHI • خاموشی

Meaning • silence, quietness **Connection** • Silence may conceal love, grief, refusal or a truth too large to speak.

Memory hook • The film title “Khamoshi” reminds us that silence can carry the whole drama.

Try it • khaamoshi ka raaz = the secret of silence

86 • GUFTAGU • گفتگو

Meaning • conversation, dialogue **Connection** • The spoken counterpart to khaamoshi; often intimate and unhurried.

Memory hook • Imagine a mehfil after the singing ends and guftagu begins.

Try it • dil ki guftagu = the heart's conversation

87 • RAAZ • راز

Meaning • secret, mystery **Connection** • A raaz can be hidden in the heart, glance, silence or universe.

Memory hook • The film title "Raaz" fixes the meaning without translation.

Try it • raaz-e-dil = secret of the heart

88 • YAQEEEN • یقین

Meaning • certainty, conviction, faith **Connection** • Stronger than umeed: hope wishes; yaqeen believes.

Memory hook • The title "Yaqeen" is a compact reminder of certainty.

Try it • khud par yaqeen = belief in oneself

89 • UMEED • امید

Meaning • hope, expectation **Connection** • A light that survives gham; it often connects to sahar and roshni.

Memory hook • The saying umeed pe duniya qayam hai makes hope the support of the world.

Try it • umeed ki kiran = a ray of hope

90 • KHAUF • خوف

Meaning • fear, dread, awe **Connection** • Can be ordinary fear or reverential awe, depending on context.

Memory hook • Place khauf beside umeed: much Urdu poetry lives between fear and hope.

Try it • khauf-e-judaai = fear of separation

How a Ghazal Is Built

غزل کی ساخت

These final words reveal the architecture. Once you can identify a couplet, refrain, rhyme and pen name, listening becomes much more rewarding.

91 • SHE'R • شعر

Meaning • a couplet or verse; in a ghazal, two lines forming one unit **Connection** • One she'r contains two misras and can often stand by itself.

Memory hook • Do not confuse شعر with شیر, sher meaning lion. Here the slight pause matters.

Try it • ek she'r = one couplet

92 • GHAZAL • غزل

Meaning • a poem of autonomous couplets sharing metre and rhyme system **Connection** • Each she'r may turn independently while sound-pattern holds the ghazal together.

Memory hook • Treat "Aaj Jaane Ki Zid Na Karo" as a listening doorway into the ghazal tradition.

Try it • ghazal ki mehfil = a gathering of ghazal

93 • NAZM • نظم

Meaning • poem; especially a thematically continuous poem **Connection** • Unlike many ghazals, a nazm usually develops one subject from beginning to end.

Memory hook • Faiz's "Bol" is a memorable doorway into the modern Urdu nazm.

Try it • ek chhoti nazm = a short poem

94 • MISRA • مصرع

Meaning • one line of a couplet **Connection** • Two misras make one she'r: misra-e-oola is first, misra-e-saani second.

Memory hook • If you memorise one line, you have half a she'r: one misra.

Try it • pehla misra = the first line

95 • MATLA • مطلع

Meaning • opening couplet of a ghazal **Connection** • In the matla, both lines display the qaafiya and radeef pattern.

Memory hook • Think of matla as the doorway where the ghazal reveals its sound rules.

Try it • ghazal ka matla = the ghazal's opening couplet

96 • MAQTA • مقطع

Meaning • closing couplet of a ghazal **Connection** • Often, though not always, it contains the poet's takhallus.

Memory hook • Matla opens; maqta closes. Learn them as a matched pair.

Try it • ghazal ka maqta = the ghazal's closing couplet

97 • RADEEF • ردیف

Meaning • the exact repeated refrain at the end of relevant lines **Connection** • It comes after the qaafiya and gives the listener a recurring landing place.

Memory hook • In Ghalib's "Dil-e-nadaan...", kya hai functions as the repeated refrain.

Try it • radeef dohraana = to repeat the refrain

98 • QAAFIYA • قافیہ

Meaning • the rhyme immediately before the radeef **Connection** • The qaafiya changes word but repeats a sound; the radeef repeats exactly.

Memory hook • Listen just before a repeated phrase—that changing rhyme is qaafiya.

Try it • qaafiya aur radeef = rhyme and refrain

99 • TAKHALLUS • تخلص

Meaning • poet's pen name **Connection** • The poet may address or mention this name in the maqta.

Memory hook • Ghalib, Mir and Firaq are famous takhallus names, not merely signatures.

Try it • shaair ka takhallus = the poet's pen name

100 • MEHFIL • محفل

Meaning • gathering, assembly; often for poetry or music **Connection** • A mushaira is a poetry gathering; a mehfil can include poetry, ghazal, music and conversation.

Memory hook • Picture singer, listeners and shared attention in one room: that atmosphere is mehfil.

Try it • mehfil-e-ghazal = a gathering of ghazal

Your First Listening Shelf

Use these as recognition exercises. Listen once for pleasure, once with the guide open, and once while noting only the words you catch.

LISTEN TO	WORDS TO CATCH	FORM / DOORWAY
Dil Dhoondta Hai	dil • yaad • safar	film song / nazm-like lyric
Ranjish Hi Sahi	ranj • gham • dil • wafa	ghazal
Aaj Jaane Ki Zid Na Karo	dil • waqt • intezaar	ghazal
Chupke Chupke Raat Din	yaad • aansoo • mohabbat	ghazal
Hoshwalon Ko Khabar Kya	hosh • ishq • khushboo	ghazal
Koi Faryaad	faryaad • dil • yaad	film ghazal
Phir Le Aaya Dil	dil • beqaraar • safar	film song with ghazal sensibility
Gulon Mein Rang Bhare	gul • bahaar • gham	Faiz ghazal
Hazaaron Khwahishen Aisi	hasrat • aarzu • maut	Ghalib ghazal
Bol	nazm • lab • zubaan	Faiz nazm
Shikwa / Jawab-e-Shikwa	shikwa • khuda • dua	Iqbal poems
Zindagi Kaisi Hai Paheli	zindagi • waqt • safar	film song / philosophical lyric

Three Listening Questions

Which emotional world dominates: ishq, hijr, gham, sukoon or junoon?	What images carry it: dil, ashk, shab, gul, jaam, khwaab or safar?	Can you hear a repeated ending that may be radeef, with rhyme before it?
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Usage note • Song and poem titles are mnemonic signposts. No full lyrics are reproduced. Meanings are poetry-first and may shift with grammar, historical usage and context.

Quick Index • All 100 Words

Cover the meaning column, identify the Roman word and Urdu shape, then check yourself.

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING
1	عشق	ishq	intense, consuming or transformative love
2	محبت	mohabbat	love, affection, loving attachment
3	دل	dil	heart; the inner seat of emotion and courage
4	جان	jaan	life, soul; also an intimate name for a beloved
5	صنم	sanam	idol; poetically, the adored beloved
6	محبوب	mehboob	the loved one, beloved
7	الفت	ulfat	affection, intimacy, loving attachment
8	وفا	wafa	faithfulness, loyalty, keeping faith in love
9	بے وفا	bewafa	unfaithful, disloyal
10	عاشق	aashiq	lover; one overcome by love
11	ہجر	hijr	separation from the beloved; the state of being apart
12	فراق	firaaq	separation, absence and longing
13	جدائی	judaai	parting, separation

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING
14	وصال	visaal	union, reunion or meeting with the beloved
15	انتظار	intezaar	waiting, expectation
16	یاد	yaad	memory, remembrance; the feeling of missing someone
17	تمنا	tamanna	desire, wish, cherished longing
18	حسرت	hasrat	unfulfilled desire, wistful longing, regret
19	آرزو	aarzu	desire, aspiration, longing
20	جستجو	justuju	search, quest, persistent seeking
21	غم	gham	sorrow, grief, emotional burden
22	درد	dard	pain, ache, suffering
23	اشک	ashk	tear; a literary word for a teardrop
24	آنسو	aansoo	tear; the common spoken word
25	آہ	aah	sigh, cry of pain
26	سوز	soz	burning emotion, passion, pathos
27	رنج	ranj	grief, hurt, trouble, distress
28	ملاال	malaal	regret, melancholy, subdued sadness
29	شکوہ	shikwa	complaint, grievance, reproach

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING
30	فرياد	faryaad	lament, cry for help, appeal
31	حسن	husn	beauty, loveliness
32	جمال	jamaal	beauty, splendour, graceful perfection
33	نظر	nazar	sight, glance, attention, viewpoint
34	نگاه	nigaah	gaze, look, regard
35	ادا	adaa	graceful style, gesture, manner, charm
36	ناز	naaz	charming pride, coyness, pampered delicacy
37	رخ	rukḥ	face; also direction or aspect
38	زلف	zulf	lock or tress of hair
39	لب	lab	lip; poetically, speech or a kiss
40	خوشبو	khushboo	fragrance, pleasant scent
41	مے	mai (may)	wine; the classical poetic word
42	شراب	sharaab	wine, alcoholic drink
43	ساقی	saaqi	cupbearer, one who pours wine
44	پیمانہ	paimaana	measure, goblet, wine-cup

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING
45	جام	jaam	goblet, cup, wine-cup
46	مے خانہ	maikhaana	tavern, house of wine
47	خمار	khumaar	lingering intoxication, dreamy after-effect
48	مست	mast	intoxicated, ecstatic, carefree
49	رند	rind	free-spirited drinker; worldly nonconformist
50	ہوش	hosh	consciousness, awareness, senses
51	چاند	chaand	moon
52	ماہ	maah	moon; also month, in Persianate usage
53	شب	shab	night
54	سحر	sahar	dawn, early morning
55	روشنی	roshni	light, illumination
56	نور	noor	radiance, luminous or spiritual light
57	آفتاب	aaftaab	sun
58	بہار	bahaar	spring, bloom, flourishing season
59	گل	gul	flower; often specifically a rose
60	گلشن	gulshan	garden, flower garden

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING
61	زندگی	zindagi	life; lived existence
62	حیات	hayaat	life, existence; formal or literary
63	موت	maut	death
64	تقدیر	taqdeer	destiny, what has been decreed
65	قسمت	qismat	fate, fortune, one's allotted share
66	وقت	waqt	time; the moment or circumstances
67	زمانہ	zamaana	age, era, the times; society or the world
68	عمر	umr	age, lifetime, span of life
69	لحہ	lamha	moment, instant
70	سفر	safar	journey, travel
71	دنیا	duniya	world; worldly or material life
72	جہاں	jahaan	world, universe, realm; also "where" by context
73	خدا	khuda	God, the Divine
74	دعا	dua	prayer, blessing, heartfelt wish
75	عبادت	ibaadat	worship, devotion

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING
76	روح	rooh	soul, spirit
77	خواب	khwaab	dream
78	خیال	khayaal	thought, imagination, idea; also care or regard
79	وجود	wajood	existence, being, presence
80	تنہا	tanha	alone, solitary, lonely
81	صبر	sabr	patient endurance, steadfast restraint
82	جنون	junoon	madness, obsession, consuming passion
83	سکون	sukoon	peace, repose, inner calm
84	بے قرار	beqaraar	restless, uneasy, unable to settle
85	خاموشی	khaamoshi	silence, quietness
86	گفتگو	guftagu	conversation, dialogue
87	راز	raaz	secret, mystery
88	یقین	yaqeen	certainty, conviction, faith
89	امید	umeed	hope, expectation
90	خوف	khauf	fear, dread, awe
91	شعر	she'r	a couplet or verse; in a ghazal, two lines forming one unit

#	URDU	ROMAN	CORE MEANING
92	غزل	ghazal	a poem of autonomous couplets sharing metre and rhyme system
93	نظم	nazm	poem; especially a thematically continuous poem
94	مصرع	misra	one line of a couplet
95	مطلع	matla	opening couplet of a ghazal
96	مقطع	maqta	closing couplet of a ghazal
97	ردیف	radeef	the exact repeated refrain at the end of relevant lines
98	قافیه	qaafiya	the rhyme immediately before the radeef
99	تخلص	takhallus	poet's pen name
100	محفل	mehfil	gathering, assembly; often for poetry or music

Where to Go Next

Volume 2 should add the working grammar of poetry: pronouns, postpositions, verb endings, negation, common Persian compounds, and close reading of twenty accessible couplets. These 100 words give that grammar something meaningful to attach to.

A good milestone • When you can hear 15–20 of these words without translating them, choose one favourite ghazal and make it your first complete study text.

Useful Reference

Rekhta Dictionary • Hear pronunciation, compare meanings and see words in literary context:
www.rekhtadictionary.com

Rekhta Poetry Archive • Use poet pages and transliteration to move from recognition to complete poems:
www.rekhta.org